



UNIVERSITY OF PATRAS
COMPUTER ENGINEERING AND INFORMATICS DEPARTMENT
MSc PROGRAM *DATA DRIVEN COMPUTING AND DECISION MAKING*

MSc topics 2019-2020
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1. Retweet prediction model for Twitter verified accounts

Social media like Twitter, currently the most popular microblogging platform, are a prime means not only for communication, but also for political campaigns and digital marketing. In this context identifying influencers is paramount as they can promote ideas and concepts easier. A starting point for discovering influencers is to consider the set of verified accounts, as typically accounts requesting this status are celebrities, institutions, companies, and existing or aspiring influencers. The proposed MSc research will develop a machine learning model for predicting whether a verified account will retweet a tweet from another verified account by estimating the probability of such an event. This is significant as on Twitter a retweet is the closest thing to an endorsement of the original tweet, although this relies heavily on the context. Moreover, frequent retweets may result in a follow or even a mutual follow between the two accounts. Finally, retweets are important in digital campaigns as they are the primary means of making a tweet viral and thus enhance its visibility. This is an indispensable tool for marketing agencies, image makers, and public relations firms.